

HORIZONTAL VS. VERTICAL JAZZ

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #53

Sometimes we hear people talking about the difference between "Horizontal Playing" and "Vertical Playing" in jazz. It's just a way of talking about the shape of the line/melody that is being played. Smoother (Horizontal, like a flat "left to right" line) versus a more angular melody (Vertical, going up and down more, and more quickly).

This begins to be a more interesting discussion when we think about how we might actually pull off one or the other of these approaches. What do we actually DO to play more Horizontally, or more Vertically? Is one better than the other? Does one PAY better than the other? Good questions!!

Horizontal = Smoother, Melodic, Scalar, Diatonic, Key Area.
Vertical = Angular, Harmonic, Arpeggios, Playing the Changes.

- #1 - Horizontal Playing typically pays better. Vertical, not as well!
- #2 - Horizontal Playing is "Easier" to begin with, Vertical is more challenging.
- #3 - Horizontal Playing is "on top of the changes", Vertical is "inside the changes."

#1 - Horizontal Playing



#2 - Vertical Playing

